

ARTICLE WRITING - Guidelines

An article is a piece of writing published in a newspaper, magazine or online platform. It is written to inform, educate, persuade, analyse or entertain readers on a particular issue or topic.

Format

1. Heading

- Should be **catchy, relevant** and **creative**
- Ideally **4–6 words**
- It should immediately attract the **reader's attention**

2. Byline

- Write the name of the writer (given in the question paper)
- If no name is given in the question, write **XYZ**

3. Body

The body should be divided into **three well-developed paragraphs**.

Paragraph 1 – Introduction

- Introduce the topic clearly.
- Explain its significance or meaning.
- Begin with a suitable quotation, proverb, rhetorical question, anecdote or surprising fact/statistic to capture the reader's interest.
- State the purpose of the article.

Paragraph 2 – Analysis/Discussion

- Discuss the issue in detail.
- Explain its causes, effects, advantages, disadvantages, challenges or importance, depending on the topic.
- Support your ideas with relevant examples, facts, illustrations or logical arguments.
- Maintain a clear and coherent flow of ideas.

Paragraph 3 – Conclusion

- Conclude by summarising the main points.
- Suggest practical solutions, recommendations, or a way forward.
- End on a positive, thought-provoking, or inspiring note.
- A relevant quotation or a strong concluding statement may be used.

Points to Remember

- Write within the prescribed **150–200 words**.
- Use **formal language** and maintain an objective tone.
- Organise ideas into **three distinct paragraphs**.
- Ensure **coherence and logical sequencing** of ideas.
- Use appropriate **linking words** such as *Moreover, Furthermore, However, Consequently, Therefore, and Hence*.
- Avoid contractions and shortforms (e.g., *don't, can't, &*).
- Keep the conclusion brief but impactful.
- Whenever discussing a problem, **always suggest feasible solutions** and provide a positive conclusion.

Sample: ARTICLE

‘Grow more trees to reduce pollution.’ Write an article in 150-200 words on the topic given above for your school magazine. You are Rohan/ Radhika.

Suggested Titles: A Breath of Fresh Air: Plant More Trees / Sow Green, Reap Clean / A Greener Planet Begins with You / The Power of Green / Every Tree Counts

anching Out Towards A Cleaner World

- RADHIKA

"Trees are poems that the earth writes upon the sky." Pollution has become one of the most pressing problems of modern times. Rapid urbanisation, industrial growth and increasing vehicular emissions have led to a significant decline in environmental quality. In such a scenario, planting more trees is one of the most effective ways to reduce pollution and restore ecological balance.

Trees act as nature's air purifiers. They absorb carbon dioxide and other harmful gases while releasing oxygen into the atmosphere. They also trap dust, smoke and pollutants, thereby improving air quality and reducing health hazards. Besides purifying the air, trees prevent soil erosion, conserve water, regulate temperature and provide habitats for numerous species. Their presence creates a healthier and more pleasant environment for all living beings.

Therefore, it is the responsibility of every citizen to support afforestation and protect existing green cover. Schools, communities and government agencies should organise tree-plantation drives and spread awareness about environmental conservation. As the saying goes, "The best time to plant a tree was twenty years ago; the second best time is now." Let us plant more trees and work together towards a cleaner, greener and pollution-free future.

PRACTICE QUESTIONS

1. Are Social Media Influencers Shaping Young Minds? (Express your views on the impact of influencers on today's youth.)
2. The Importance of Preserving Local Languages and Cultures (Discuss the need to protect cultural heritage in a globalised world.)
3. The Power of Kindness in a Competitive World (Explain how empathy and compassion can transform society.)

